CHARLES AND DELIA DEETZ, AT HOME

Dinner at THE DEETZES'



NETHERWORLD
TAKE A NUMBER
No. 88
Please wait. Then wait.

Winter River, to scale. Found in the attic.

DELIA DEETZ
Dinner Guest, No. 3, 1988
Welded steel, fun fur, nerve.
Do not touch. Otho insists.

Saturday at eight

The Maitland house,
remodelled at last.
Dress: strange and unusual.



Before Delia.

THIS EVENING

THE MENU

TO BEGIN

Shrimp cocktail

Chilled shrimp, iceberg, lemony horseradish sauce.

Served lively. Keep your face clear of the bowl.

Otho's spiral breadsticks

Black and white sesame twists, baked crisp.

Model town cheeses

Cheese houses, cherry tomato and cornichon trees.

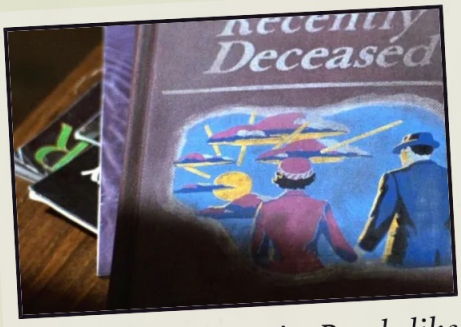


The shrimp cocktail. It grabs back.

THE MAIN EVENT

Grilled lobster tails

Garlic and parsley butter, shoestring fries, salad.



Found in the attic. Reads like stereo instructions.

AFTERWARDS

Black and white cake

Vanilla and chocolate sponge, white ganache.

Delia's meringue sculpture

Meringue spires, whipped cream, blackberry swirl.

Please do touch this one.

LATE NIGHT TV

BIO-EXORCIST

Got the living in your house?
Seen The Exorcist 167 times.

No phone. Just say the name.

TO DRINK

Banana daiquiri

Banana, lime, sugar syrup and ice. No rum.

May cause sudden dancing. Resist.

Sparkling lemonade

Pressed lemons, cane sugar, soda water.

HOUSE RULE Do not say the host's name three times.

Menu by Delia. Table by Otho. Winter River, Connecticut, 1988.

PREP SHEET

BEETLEJUICE

SHOPPING LIST

SEAFOOD

- [ ] 500g green prawns
- [ ] 4 lobster tails

DELI

- [ ] 120g gouda
- [ ] 120g pepper jack

PRODUCE

- [ ] 1 iceberg lettuce
- [ ] 2 lemon
- [ ] 250g cherry tomatoes
- [ ] 2 garlic cloves
- [ ] 1 bunch parsley
- [ ] 800g potatoes
- [ ] 100g salad leaves
- [ ] 3 limes
- [ ] 2 bananas

DAIRY

- [ ] 120g cheddar
- [ ] 280g butter
- [ ] 4 eggs
- [ ] 80ml full cream milk
- [ ] 60ml thickened cream

FROZEN

- [ ] 1kg ice

PANTRY

- [ ] 120g mayonnaise
- [ ] 2 tbsp tomato sauce
- [ ] 1 tsp horseradish
- [ ] 1 tsp hot sauce
- [ ] 100g cornichons
- [ ] 1.5L vegetable oil
- [ ] 260g caster sugar
- [ ] 250g self-raising flour
- [ ] 2 tbsp cocoa
- [ ] 150g white chocolate
- [ ] 50g dark chocolate

BOTTLE SHOP

- [ ] 180ml white rum

HOW TO MAKE IT

1 **Banana Boat prawn cocktail** SNACK

Poach 500g peeled green prawns for 2 minutes in salted water, then chill in iced water. Mix 120g mayonnaise, 2 tbsp tomato sauce, 1 tsp horseradish, a squeeze of lemon and a dash of hot sauce. Shred half an iceberg lettuce into four glasses, pile in the prawns and spoon the sauce over.

2 **Model town cheese bites** SNACK

Cut 120g cheddar, 120g gouda and 120g pepper jack into cubes and stack into tiny houses on a long board. Thread 250g cherry tomatoes and 100g cornichons onto toothpicks as trees between them, like Adam's model town.

3 **Dinner party lobster** MAIN

Split 4 lobster tails lengthways. Mash 80g soft butter with 2 crushed garlic cloves, lemon zest and chopped parsley and brush over the flesh. Grill flesh side up for 6 minutes until just opaque. Fry 800g potatoes cut into shoestrings at 180C until crisp and serve with 100g salad leaves dressed in lemon.

4 **Striped suit cake** SWEET

Beat 200g butter and 200g sugar, add 4 eggs and fold in 250g self-raising flour with 80ml milk. Stir 2 tbsp cocoa into half the batter. Pipe alternating stripes into a loaf tin and bake at 170C for 50 minutes. Melt 150g white chocolate with 60ml cream and pour over, then pipe stripes with 50g melted dark chocolate.

5 **Banana daiquiri** DRINK

Dissolve 60g caster sugar in 60ml hot water and cool. For four drinks, blend 180ml white rum, 80ml lime juice, 60ml syrup and 2 ripe bananas with 4 cups of ice until smooth. Pour into chilled glasses.

SHOWTIME CUE Serve the prawns when the dinner party breaks into the Banana Boat song.